100 DIFFICULT SENTENCE CORRECTION MCQs

Advanced Placement / Competitive Exam Practice • Solutions at the End

Instructions: Choose the grammatically correct option. These questions focus on advanced agreement, inversion, conditionals, subjunctive mood, modifiers, relative clauses, verb patterns, prepositions, and tricky constructions.

1. Had the committee _____ the proposal earlier, the implementation would not have been delayed.

A. approved
B. had approved
C. approve
D. has approved

2. No sooner _____ the announcement than the candidates began submitting objections.

A. did the board make
B. had the board made
C. the board had made
D. has the board made

3. Scarcely _____ the negotiations when the minister withdrew his offer.

A. had they begun
B. they had begun
C. did they begin
D. have they begun

4. The CEO demanded that every employee _____ the revised compliance policy by Friday.

A. reads
B. read
C. has read
D. reading

5. It is imperative that the report _____ before the auditors arrive.

A. is completed
B. be completed
C. was completed
D. has been completed

6. The principal objection was not that the plan was expensive, but that it _____ impractical.

A. is
B. was
C. be
D. has been

7. Neither the revised guidelines nor the accompanying circular _____ sufficient clarification.

A. provide
B. provides
C. providing
D. have provided

8. A series of unexpected outages _____ the company to reconsider its backup strategy.

A. have forced
B. has forced

C. were forcing
D. are forcing

9. The number of applicants who have cleared the first round _____ risen sharply.

A. have
B. has
C. are
D. were

10. A number of applicants who _____ shortlisted are awaiting the interview schedule.

A. was
B. has been
C. have been
D. is

11. The researcher is one of those scientists who _____ reluctant to publish preliminary findings.

A. is
B. are
C. was
D. has

12. He is the only one of the researchers who _____ the anomaly before publication.

A. noticed
B. notice
C. have noticed
D. are noticing

13. The report, together with its appendices, _____ to be circulated before the meeting.

A. are scheduled
B. were scheduled
C. is scheduled
D. have been scheduled

14. What the investigators discovered _____ more disturbing than anyone had anticipated.

A. were
B. have been
C. was
D. are

15. What appear to be minor discrepancies _____ actually evidence of a larger accounting problem.

A. is
B. was
C. has been
D. are

16. The committee recommended that the contract _____ renegotiated before renewal.

A. is
B. was
C. be
D. has been

17. She would rather the issue _____ discussed privately than debated in public.

A. is
B. was
C. be
D. has been

18. I would sooner you _____ the matter with the legal team before responding.

A. discuss
B. discussed
C. had discussed
D. have discussed

19. If the data _____ independently verified, the conclusion would have been different.

A. were
B. had been

C. have been
D. would be

20. If I _____ about the change earlier, I would not be asking you now.

A. knew
B. had known
C. have known
D. would know

21. Were the company _____ its current policy, several compliance issues could arise.

A. to retain
B. retaining
C. retained
D. has retained

22. Had it not been _____ your intervention, the agreement would have collapsed.

A. for
B. with
C. by
D. from

23. The manager denied _____ the confidential figures to the press.

A. to leak
B. having leaked
C. to have leaked
D. that he leaking

24. The witness claimed _____ the suspect at the station earlier that evening.

A. to see
B. having seen
C. to have seen
D. that seeing

25. The proposal is believed _____ substantial financial implications.

A. having
B. to have
C. to having
D. that have

26. The new regulation is expected _____ into force next quarter.

A. come
B. to come
C. coming
D. to have come

27. Having _____ the contract carefully, the lawyer identified three ambiguous clauses.

A. review
B. reviewed
C. been review
D. reviewing

28. The documents _____ by the auditor yesterday have already been archived.

A. reviewed
B. reviewing
C. were reviewed
D. having reviewed

29. The minister, _____ by several senior officials, entered the conference hall.

A. accompanied
B. accompanying
C. was accompanied

D. having accompanying

30. The evidence was too ambiguous _____ a definitive conclusion.

A. to draw
B. for drawing
C. that draw
D. as to drawing

31. The instructions were so confusing _____ several participants interpreted them differently.

A. as
B. that
C. to
D. than

32. It was such a complex issue _____ even experienced analysts disagreed.

A. that
B. as
C. to
D. which

33. The project was completed in half the time _____ had originally been estimated.

A. that
B. what
C. which
D. than

34. The salary package is considerably higher than _____ offered by competing firms.

A. those
B. that
C. what
D. one

35. The two proposals differ considerably from _____ submitted last year.

A. that
B. those
C. one
D. it

36. She is senior _____ all the other members of the team.

A. than
B. to
C. from
D. with

37. The new system is superior _____ the legacy platform in terms of scalability.

A. than
B. to
C. from
D. with

38. He has little interest _____ taking responsibility for the failed rollout.

A. on
B. in
C. at
D. for

39. The committee is committed _____ maintaining strict confidentiality.

A. to
B. for
C. with

D. at

40. The consultant objected _____ the assumption that the existing process was adequate.

A. against
B. to
C. for
D. with

41. They insisted _____ seeing the original documents before signing.

A. to
B. on
C. for
D. at

42. The candidate succeeded _____ convincing the panel despite limited experience.

A. in
B. at
C. to
D. for

43. The report consists _____ five sections and two appendices.

A. with
B. of
C. from
D. in

44. The manager was accused _____ manipulating the figures.

A. for
B. with
C. of
D. about

45. The new policy is aimed _____ reducing unnecessary expenditure.

A. to
B. at
C. for
D. on

46. There is little point _____ reopening a matter that has already been settled.

A. to
B. in
C. for
D. at

47. It is no use _____ with someone who has already made up his mind.

A. to argue
B. arguing
C. argued
D. to have argued

48. The CEO is responsible _____ ensuring that all statutory requirements are met.

A. to
B. for
C. of
D. with

49. The issue is worth _____ further before a final decision is made.

A. to investigate
B. investigating
C. investigated

D. to be investigating

50. The board agreed to postpone the launch, _____ the concerns raised by the safety team.

A. despite
B. although
C. because
D. whereas

51. _____ the severe weather, the flight operated as scheduled.

A. Although
B. Despite
C. Because
D. Whereas

52. _____ he had little experience, he managed the negotiation effectively.

A. Despite
B. Although
C. In spite
D. Nevertheless

53. The company will proceed with the acquisition _____ the regulators impose additional conditions.

A. unless
B. provided
C. even if
D. whether

54. You may access the system _____ you comply with the security requirements.

A. unless
B. provided that
C. despite
D. whereas

55. The contract cannot be terminated _____ both parties agree in writing.

A. if
B. unless
C. whether
D. although

56. He spoke as though he _____ the entire incident himself.

A. witnesses
B. had witnessed
C. has witnessed
D. would witness

57. She behaves as if she _____ the authority to approve such expenditures.

A. has
B. had
C. would have
D. having

58. By the time the auditors arrive, we _____ the reconciliation.

A. complete
B. completed
C. will have completed
D. have completed

59. By next June, she _____ at the company for ten years.

A. will work
B. will have worked

C. has worked
D. had worked

60. The company _____ the issue for months before the regulator intervened.

A. has been investigating
B. had been investigating
C. was investigated
D. is investigating

61. I _____ him three times this week, but he has not responded.

A. contacted
B. have contacted
C. had contacted
D. am contacting

62. When I reached the station, the train _____ already _____.

A. has; left
B. had; left
C. was; leaving
D. would; leave

63. He said that he _____ the report the following day.

A. will submit
B. would submit
C. has submitted
D. submits

64. She asked me whether I _____ the revised draft.

A. have received
B. had received
C. receive
D. will receive

65. The manager said that the figures _____ inaccurate and needed verification.

A. are
B. were
C. have been
D. will be

66. The consultant suggested that the company _____ a second opinion.

A. takes
B. take
C. took
D. has taken

67. The director insisted that no employee _____ the premises without authorization.

A. leaves
B. leave
C. left
D. has left

68. The report needs _____ before it is circulated to clients.

A. to revise
B. revising
C. revised
D. to be revised

69. The equipment requires _____ before it can be used safely.

A. to inspect
B. inspecting
C. inspected

D. to be inspecting

70. He had his assistant _____ the documents before the meeting.

A. to print
B. printed
C. print
D. printing

71. She got the technician _____ the network configuration.

A. change
B. to change
C. changed
D. changing

72. The supervisor made the interns _____ the procedure again.

A. to repeat
B. repeated
C. repeat
D. repeating

73. The interns were made _____ the procedure again.

A. repeat
B. to repeat
C. repeating
D. repeated

74. The more carefully you analyse the data, _____ the likelihood of error.

A. the smaller
B. smaller
C. smallest
D. the smallest

75. The harder he worked, _____ his chances of promotion became.

A. the better
B. better
C. the best
D. best

76. It was _____ that the entire audience remained silent.

A. so compelling a presentation
B. such compelling presentation
C. so a compelling presentation
D. such a compelling presentation

77. It was _____ that several reviewers questioned its authenticity.

A. such sophisticated a forgery
B. so sophisticated forgery
C. such a sophisticated forgery
D. so a sophisticated forgery

78. Not only _____ the deadline, but he also failed to inform the client.

A. he missed
B. did he miss
C. he had missed
D. has he missed

79. Rarely _____ such a comprehensive audit report.

A. we receive
B. do we receive
C. we received

D. have we receiving

80. Only after the investigation _____ the extent of the irregularities.

A. the auditors understood
B. did the auditors understand
C. had the auditors understood
D. the auditors had understood

81. Under no circumstances _____ confidential data to external parties.

A. employees should disclose
B. should employees disclose
C. employees disclose
D. do employees should disclose

82. The proposal is likely _____ rejected unless substantial changes are made.

A. being
B. to be
C. to have
D. that it be

83. The witness was the last person _____ the building.

A. leave
B. to leave
C. leaving
D. left

84. There is no reason _____ the deadline at this stage.

A. to extend
B. extending
C. for extend
D. to extending

85. The report contains several recommendations, many of _____ have already been implemented.

A. that
B. which
C. them
D. what

86. The candidates, none of _____ had prior experience, performed well.

A. who
B. whom
C. which
D. them

87. The manager asked the employee _____ laptop had been left in the conference room.

A. who
B. whom
C. whose
D. which

88. This is the most comprehensive report _____ has been published on the issue.

A. which
B. that
C. what
D. whom

89. The strategy _____ we adopted last quarter has significantly reduced costs.

A. what
B. which
C. whose

D. where

90. The city in _____ the headquarters is located has introduced new tax incentives.

A. that
B. which
C. where
D. what

91. The reason _____ the project was delayed remains unclear.

A. because
B. why
C. for
D. which

92. The extent to _____ the findings can be generalized remains uncertain.

A. that
B. which
C. what
D. where

93. He is one of the few candidates who _____ both technical and managerial experience.

A. has
B. have
C. is having
D. was

94. She is the only candidate who _____ all the required certifications.

A. possess
B. possesses
C. have
D. are possessing

95. Neither the evidence nor the witness statements _____ sufficient to establish liability.

A. was
B. has been
C. were
D. is

96. Either the finance team or the external auditors _____ responsible for verifying the figures.

A. is
B. are
C. has
D. was

97. The principal, as well as the vice-principals, _____ expected to attend the hearing.

A. are
B. were
C. is
D. have

98. Not until the final audit _____ the discrepancy become apparent.

A. did
B. had
C. has
D. was

99. So complicated _____ that even specialists disagreed about its interpretation.

A. the contract was
B. was the contract
C. the contract is

D. is the contract

100. Had the warning been heeded, the accident _____.

A. would avoid
B. would have been avoided
C. will have been avoided
D. had avoided

SOLUTIONS & EXPLANATIONS

Answer key first, followed by the grammar point tested.

1. Answer: B. had approved
Past unreal conditional: Had + subject + past participle, ... would have + past participle.

2. Answer: B. had the board made
With 'No sooner', inversion is used: No sooner had + subject + past participle + than.

3. Answer: A. had they begun
After 'Scarcely/Hardly', past perfect with inversion is standard: Scarcely had they begun...

4. Answer: B. read
Mandative subjunctive after 'demanded that': base form 'read'.

5. Answer: B. be completed
Mandative subjunctive in passive: 'that ... be completed'.

6. Answer: B. was
Parallel past-tense structure: was expensive / was impractical.

7. Answer: B. provides
With neither...nor, the verb agrees with the nearer subject 'circular' (singular).

8. Answer: B. has forced
'A series' is singular, so 'has forced'.

9. Answer: B. has
'The number' is singular; use 'has risen'.

10. Answer: C. have been
'A number of' takes a plural verb: applicants have been shortlisted.

11. Answer: B. are
Relative pronoun refers to plural 'scientists', so 'are'.

12. Answer: A. noticed
'The only one' is singular; the relative clause modifies one, so singular verb/tense is required.

13. Answer: C. is scheduled
Main subject 'report' is singular; intervening phrase does not affect agreement.

14. Answer: C. was
The subject is the singular noun clause 'What the investigators discovered'; use 'was'.

15. Answer: D. are
The relative clause refers to plural 'discrepancies'; use 'are'.

16. Answer: C. be
After 'recommended that', formal English uses the mandative subjunctive: 'be renegotiated'.

17. Answer: B. was
'Would rather + subject' for a present/future preference takes simple past: 'was discussed'.

18. Answer: B. discussed
'Would sooner/would rather + subject' takes simple past for present/future preference.

19. Answer: B. had been
Third conditional: if + past perfect, would have + past participle.

20. Answer: B. had known
Mixed conditional: past condition ('had known') with present result ('would not be asking').

21. Answer: A. to retain
Inverted second conditional: Were + subject + to-infinitive.

22. Answer: A. for
Fixed construction: 'Had it not been for...'

23. Answer: B. having leaked
'Deny' takes a gerund; 'having leaked' emphasizes prior action.

24. Answer: C. to have seen
Perfect infinitive 'to have seen' expresses an earlier action.

25. Answer: B. to have
Passive reporting verb + perfect infinitive: 'is believed to have'.

26. Answer: B. to come
Expected + to-infinitive for a future event.

27. Answer: B. reviewed
Perfect participial clause: Having + past participle.

28. Answer: A. reviewed
Reduced relative clause: documents [that were] reviewed yesterday.

29. Answer: A. accompanied
Past participle phrase modifies 'minister': 'accompanied by'.

30. Answer: A. to draw
Too + adjective + to-infinitive: too ambiguous to draw.

31. Answer: B. that
So + adjective + that + clause.

32. Answer: A. that
Such + noun phrase + that + clause.

33. Answer: C. which
Relative pronoun 'which' refers to the amount of time.

34. Answer: B. that
'Salary package' is singular; 'that' substitutes for the singular noun phrase.

35. Answer: B. those
'Proposals' is plural, so 'those' replaces plural noun phrase.

36. Answer: B. to
Senior is followed by 'to', not 'than'.

37. Answer: B. to
Superior takes 'to'.

38. Answer: B. in
Correct collocation: interest in + gerund.

39. Answer: A. to
Committed to + gerund/noun.

40. Answer: B. to
Object to + noun/gerund.

41. Answer: B. on
Insist on + gerund.

42. Answer: A. in
Succeed in + gerund.

43. Answer: B. of
Consist of is the correct construction.

44. Answer: C. of
Accused of + gerund/noun.

45. Answer: B. at
Be aimed at + gerund.

46. Answer: B. in
There is no/little point in + gerund.

47. Answer: B. arguing
No use + gerund.

48. Answer: B. for
Responsible for + gerund.

49. Answer: B. investigating
Worth is followed by a gerund.

50. Answer: A. despite
'Despite' is followed by a noun phrase: the concerns.

51. Answer: B. Despite
Despite + noun phrase.

52. Answer: B. Although
Although introduces a clause with subject + verb.

53. Answer: C. even if
Even if means the acquisition will proceed despite the condition.

54. Answer: B. provided that
Provided that introduces a condition.

55. Answer: B. unless
Unless = if not; termination cannot occur if both do not agree.

56. Answer: B. had witnessed
As though referring to a past unreal experience uses past perfect.

57. Answer: B. had
As if for an unreal/present hypothetical situation commonly takes past tense.

58. Answer: C. will have completed
Future perfect shows completion before a future point.

59. Answer: B. will have worked
Future perfect for duration completed by a future point.

60. Answer: B. had been investigating
Past perfect continuous for an ongoing action before a past event.

61. Answer: B. have contacted
An unfinished time period ('this week') commonly takes present perfect.

62. Answer: B. had; left
Past perfect marks an earlier past action.

63. Answer: B. would submit
Reported speech: will → would after a past reporting verb.

64. Answer: B. had received
Backshift in reported speech: have received → had received.

65. Answer: B. were
Backshift after past reporting verb: are → were.

66. Answer: B. take
Suggest + that + base verb in formal mandative construction.

67. Answer: B. leave
Insist + that + base form in mandative subjunctive.

68. Answer: D. to be revised
Needs to be revised is the clearest passive construction; 'needs revising' is also grammatical in British English, but D is the intended formal answer.

69. Answer: B. inspecting
Require + gerund can have passive meaning: requires inspecting.

70. Answer: C. print
Causative 'have + object + base verb': had his assistant print.

71. Answer: B. to change
Causative 'get + object + to-infinitive'.

72. Answer: C. repeat
Make + object + bare infinitive in active voice.

73. Answer: B. to repeat
In passive, make takes to-infinitive: were made to repeat.

74. Answer: A. the smaller
Correlative comparative: the more..., the + comparative.

75. Answer: A. the better
The more..., the better... structure.

76. Answer: A. so compelling a presentation
So + adjective + a/an + singular noun is correct.

77. Answer: C. such a sophisticated forgery
Such + a/an + adjective + singular noun.

78. Answer: B. did he miss
When 'not only' begins the sentence, auxiliary inversion is required.

79. Answer: B. do we receive
Negative/restrictive adverbial at the beginning triggers inversion.

80. Answer: B. did the auditors understand
'Only after...' fronting triggers subject-auxiliary inversion.

81. Answer: B. should employees disclose
Negative fronted expression requires inversion: should employees disclose.

82. Answer: B. to be
Likely + to-infinitive; passive requires 'to be rejected'.

83. Answer: B. to leave
The last/first/only + noun commonly takes to-infinitive.

84. Answer: A. to extend
Reason + to-infinitive.

85. Answer: B. which
Non-defining relative clause: many of which.

86. Answer: B. whom
After 'none of' referring to people in a relative clause, 'whom' is the formal object form.

87. Answer: C. whose
'Whose' indicates possession.

88. Answer: B. that
After a superlative, 'that' is commonly preferred in a restrictive relative clause.

89. Answer: B. which
Which refers to the strategy and functions as object of adopted.

90. Answer: B. which
After a preposition, formal relative pronoun is 'which': in which.

91. Answer: B. why
'The reason why' is grammatical; 'the reason because' is nonstandard in this construction.

92. Answer: B. which
Fixed construction: extent to which.

93. Answer: B. have
Relative clause modifies plural 'candidates'; use 'have'.

94. Answer: B. possesses
Relative clause refers to singular 'candidate'; use 'possesses'.

95. Answer: C. were
Nearer subject 'witness statements' is plural, so 'were'.

96. Answer: B. are
Nearer subject 'external auditors' is plural, so 'are'.

97. Answer: C. is
Main subject 'principal' is singular; 'as well as' does not change agreement.

98. Answer: A. did
Fronted 'Not until' triggers inversion: did the discrepancy become.

99. Answer: B. was the contract
So + adjective at the beginning triggers inversion: So complicated was the contract...

100. Answer: B. would have been avoided
Third conditional passive: would have been avoided.